Finding new solutions

Seafood consumption has risen from 21.8 lb (9.9 kg) per capita annually in the 1960s to more than 44lb (20 kg) in 2016. Global demand is predicted to reach around 236 million tons by 2030. Aquaculture, the farming of fish and seafood, has begun to meet much of the demand and has the potential to reduce the pressures on wild fish stocks. However, aquaculture has its own problems. Nutrients and solids added to the water can cause the environment to degrade. The buildup of organic matter from many fish in a farm can change the sediment chemistry, which has an impact on the surrounding water. Fish may escape, introducing alien species or diseases into the outside freshwater or marine environment.

While fish farming helps meet demand, overfishing still poses huge dangers for the health of the world's marine ecosystems, and the economic future of many nations. The Canadian moratorium severely disrupted the economy and culture of Newfoundland and neighboring maritime provinces. To avoid such crises, more governments will have to develop sustainable fishing practices, and protect the health of ecosystems and fish stocks.